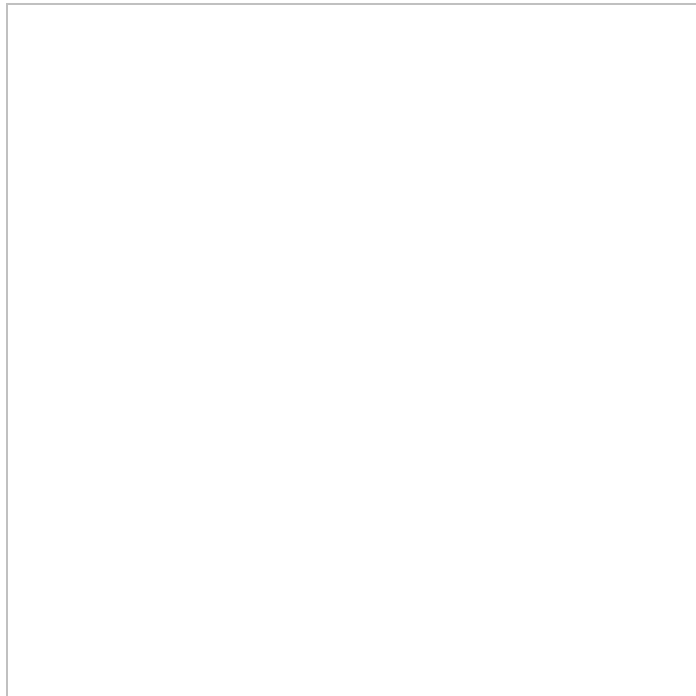




THE DUKE OF SAXE-WEIMAR

In 1708, Bach took a position as chamber musician in the court of Duke Wilhelm Ernst of Saxe-Weimar, who ruled over the duchy with his brother, Johann Ernst.

The Köthen years

Although it is notoriously difficult to date many of Bach's compositions, it was probably at Köthen that he wrote such masterpieces as the Concerto for Two Violins, the Suites for Solo Cello, and the Sonatas and Partitas for Solo Violin. The Brandenburg Concertos, six works based on the Italian concerto grosso style in which soloists play together with a small orchestra, were written in 1721, and the first book of the Well-Tempered Clavier—24 preludes and fugues in the full range of major and minor keys— was completed the following year.